

Simphiwe Sikhonde

DevOps Engineer

CORE SKILLS

- GitHub Actions
- Jenkins
- Grafana
- Prometheus
- Victoria Metrics
- Zabbix
- Grafana Loki
- Elastic Stack (ELK)
- GitHub
- GitLab
- Kubernetes
- OpenShift
- Docker
- Docker Compose
- SSL Certificates
- Firewall rules
- Cloud Private Network
- Security Groups
- Identity Access Management
- Terraform
- Ansible
- Linux (SUSE, Redhat, Ubuntu, CentOS)
- Python
- Shell/Bash scripting

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Cloud Practitioner
- Certificate: Business & Systems Analysis

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering (Electronics), University of Swaziland, 2004 - 2010
- Senior Certificate (Grade 12 / Matric), Shashe River School, Botswana, 1999 - 2003

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced DevOps and Cloud Infrastructure Engineer with over a decade of expertise in designing, automating, and managing resilient IT platforms. Skilled in CI/CD, containerisation, monitoring, and cloud provisioning, with a proven track record of delivering secure, scalable solutions across enterprise environments. AWS Certified Solutions Architect with strong proficiency in infrastructure as code, application management, and incident response.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer

BMW Group SA (IT Hub)

Nov 2023 - Present

- Implemented comprehensive application and infrastructure monitoring using Grafana and Prometheus, enhancing visibility and reliability.
- Administered Java-based services on Tomcat middleware, ensuring robust application stack management on SUSE Linux.
- Established centralised logging with Grafana Loki, improving troubleshooting and audit capabilities.
- Developed and maintained CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions, automating software delivery from code commit to deployment.
- Provisioned and managed Azure infrastructure with Terraform, ensuring consistent and repeatable deployments.
- Standardised environments and automated setup tasks with Ansible, reducing manual configuration errors.
- Managed SSL certificates to secure application communications.
- Led incident response and troubleshooting, minimising downtime and ensuring rapid resolution of critical issues.

DevOps Engineer

ABSA

Jul 2021 - Oct 2023

- Integrated GitHub Actions into deployment pipelines, automating Ansible-driven WAR file deployments.
- Deployed and managed Grafana with Prometheus/Victoria Metrics for advanced monitoring across multiple environments.
- Administered Java-based services on JBOSS middleware, overseeing application stack management on Redhat Linux.
- Resolved complex Linux server issues, including network, firewall, permissions, and performance troubleshooting.
- Generated, installed, and managed SSL certificates, ensuring secure communications and compliance.
- Provisioned AWS infrastructure using Terraform, including EC2 instances, Security Groups, and storage.

- Participated in incident management, rapidly diagnosing and resolving application issues to maintain service continuity.

DevOps Engineer

Bayport International Group Support

Jul 2019 - Jun 2021

- Automated ETL application artifact deployments to virtual machines, streamlining release processes.
- Created Jenkins jobs integrated with Ansible Tower, enabling self-service deployments for users.
- Managed artifact delivery from Artifactory repositories, ensuring reliable deployment to target servers.
- Configured environments, including cron job management, file permissions, and cleanup tasks.
- Generated SSL certificates using OpenSSL, embedding organisational details and ensuring secure key management.
- Set up isolated OpenShift projects for microservice deployment, improving environment segregation.
- Packaged microservice code into container images and managed image registries for scalable deployments.
- Defined and managed deployments for microservice Pods, optimising resource allocation and scaling.
- Implemented Grafana and Prometheus for monitoring, enhancing operational insight.
- Troubleshoot Linux server issues, including network, firewall, and performance optimisation.

DevOps Engineer

dotModus

Feb 2019 - Jun 2019

- Developed Dockerfiles to containerise applications, ensuring consistency across environments.
- Set up and managed CI/CD pipelines with Brigade CI, accelerating release cycles for Docker containers.
- Utilised GitHub for version control of Python code, fostering collaborative development and code integrity.

End-to-End Systems Integration Engineer / Decoder Software Systems Integration Engineer / Graduate Trainee

MultiChoice

Aug 2010 - Jan 2019

- Maintained and managed monitoring equipment and test labs, ensuring high-quality deployments.
- Translated product requirements into technical designs, supporting enterprise-wide set top box software integration.
- Automated configuration and change management using Jenkins and Python scripting.
- Developed Python scripts for catalogue generation and test automation.
- Integrated applications, middleware, and drivers on Set-Top-Box platforms, troubleshooting and resolving defects.

- Contributed to process improvements in systems integration and software testing.
- Maintained continuous integration branches in GIT, supporting collaborative development.
- Developed Java X-lets for middleware testing, enhancing embedded software quality.
- Interfaced with third-party developers and vendors, ensuring seamless integration and support.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Successfully automated CI/CD pipelines and infrastructure provisioning across multiple cloud and on-premise environments.
- Enhanced monitoring and centralised logging, significantly improving incident response and operational visibility.
- Led secure SSL certificate management processes, ensuring compliance and robust encryption for enterprise applications.
- Implemented containerisation and orchestration strategies, accelerating deployment cycles and improving scalability.
- Contributed to major process improvements in systems integration and software testing, reducing defects and increasing reliability.